

AUTOMATED PODCAST TRANSCRIPTION AND TOPIC SEGMENTATION

Aditi Chintawar
Department of Computer
Science and Engineering
MGM's College of Engineering
Nanded, India
chintawaraditi@gmail.com

Asst. Prof. Sagar Neralkar
Department of Computer
Science and Engineering
MGM's College of Engineering
Nanded, India

Abstract— The exponential growth of digital audio content, particularly podcasts, has created significant challenges in efficiently understanding, organizing, and extracting meaningful insights from lengthy audio conversations. This paper presents an “AI Podcast Analysis System,” an intelligent and modular framework designed for automated podcast transcription, semantic analysis, and content understanding using Artificial Intelligence and Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques. The proposed system integrates speech-to-text transcription using Faster Whisper, topic segmentation, transformer-based semantic embeddings, AI-powered summarization, keyword extraction, sentiment analysis, and interactive chatbot-based retrieval to generate meaningful insights from podcast audio. Additionally, the framework supports real-time live caption generation synchronized with audio playback, visualization dashboards for analytical interpretation, word cloud generation, and downloadable CSV reports for structured content analysis. The system utilizes Sentence Transformers (MiniLM embeddings) for semantic similarity-based contextual retrieval and enables users to ask intelligent questions related to podcast content through an AI-powered assistant. Experimental evaluation demonstrated high transcription accuracy, efficient sentiment classification, and improved semantic understanding while significantly reducing the manual effort required to analyze long-duration podcasts.

Keywords— Podcast Analysis, Speech-to-Text Transcription, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Faster Whisper, Sentiment Analysis, Topic Segmentation, Transformer Embeddings, AI Chatbot, Live Captions, Semantic Analysis, Audio Intelligence, Deep Learning.

I. INTRODUCTION

The rapid growth of digital audio platforms and podcasting services has led to an unprecedented increase in long-form spoken content across domains such as education, entertainment, business, healthcare, and technology. Podcasts have become an important medium for information sharing and knowledge dissemination; however, manually understanding, summarizing, and extracting useful insights from lengthy audio recordings remains a time-consuming and inefficient process. Users often face difficulties in identifying relevant discussions, key topics, emotional tone, and actionable insights from long-duration podcasts without listening to the entire content [1]. Furthermore, the absence of structured analysis mechanisms limits accessibility and efficient information retrieval from podcast-based knowledge sources.

To address these challenges, this work introduces the “AI Podcast Analysis System,” an intelligent framework designed for automated podcast transcription, semantic understanding, and audio content analysis using Artificial Intelligence (AI)

and Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques. The proposed system is architected as an integrated solution for the automated ingestion, transcription, and interpretation of podcast audio files. The framework enables users to upload podcast recordings and automatically generate structured textual insights through advanced AI-powered processing pipelines.

By shifting the burden of lengthy manual podcast listening to an automated AI-driven framework, the proposed system significantly improves podcast accessibility, reduces content consumption time, and enhances semantic understanding of spoken information. The integration of transformer-based sentence embeddings, semantic similarity analysis, and real-time captioning mechanisms makes the system an intelligent audio analytics platform capable of improving content discovery, contextual understanding, and information retrieval from long-form audio recordings.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

The evolution of automated audio analysis systems has progressed significantly from traditional speech recognition approaches to advanced deep learning and Natural Language Processing (NLP)-based frameworks. Recent developments in speech-to-text systems, semantic analysis, transformer embeddings, and intelligent conversational interfaces have enabled efficient understanding of long-form audio content such as podcasts.

A. Traditional Speech Recognition and Audio Processing Systems

Early speech recognition systems primarily relied on rule-based acoustic modeling and statistical language processing techniques for converting speech into text. Conventional approaches such as Hidden Markov Models (HMMs) and Gaussian Mixture Models (GMMs) demonstrated acceptable performance for structured speech environments but faced substantial limitations when processing noisy, long-duration, or multi-speaker audio content [2]. Furthermore, traditional transcription systems lacked semantic understanding capabilities, restricting their functionality to plain text conversion without contextual interpretation or insight generation [3]. The proposed AI Podcast Analysis System addresses these limitations by integrating advanced speech recognition with semantic understanding mechanisms to improve podcast accessibility and content comprehension..

B. Transformer Models and Semantic Embeddings for Audio Understanding

The emergence of Transformer-based deep learning models has significantly improved the performance of speech processing and semantic understanding systems. Pre-trained architectures such as BERT, Whisper, and Sentence Transformers have demonstrated superior contextual understanding by learning semantic relationships between textual representations [4]. Among these approaches, lightweight embedding models such as MiniLM offer efficient semantic vector generation suitable for real-time applications and resource-constrained environments [5]. In the proposed system, Faster Whisper is utilized for high-speed and accurate speech-to-text transcription, while Sentence Transformer MiniLM embeddings are employed for semantic similarity analysis, topic segmentation, and intelligent podcast-based question-answering functionality.

C. Sentiment Analysis, Topic Segmentation, and Intelligent Podcast Retrieval

Sentiment analysis and topic detection have become essential components in intelligent multimedia understanding systems. Traditional sentiment classification techniques relied on lexicon-based methods, whereas modern NLP systems leverage contextual embeddings to understand emotional tone and conversational meaning [6]. Similarly, topic segmentation methods have evolved from frequency-based clustering to semantic similarity-based grouping techniques capable of identifying meaningful conversational boundaries in long audio streams. Existing podcast analytics solutions primarily focus on transcription and keyword generation but often fail to provide intelligent semantic interaction, live captioning, and contextual retrieval capabilities. The proposed AI Podcast Analysis System overcomes these limitations through section-wise sentiment analysis using TextBlob, semantic topic segmentation, keyword extraction, live caption generation, and an AI-powered chatbot that enables users to ask contextual questions directly related to podcast content.

III. PROPOSED SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE & FEATURES

The proposed framework, Poddy: AI Podcast Analysis and Intelligent Conversational Assistant System, is designed as a modular and scalable architecture that automates podcast understanding, transcript generation, semantic retrieval, and intelligent user interaction. The system integrates speech processing, Natural Language Processing (NLP), semantic embeddings, and conversational AI into a unified platform for podcast intelligence.

The architecture is divided into four major technical layers:

A. Audio Ingestion & Speech Processing Layer

The first layer is responsible for acquiring podcast content from uploaded audio files or YouTube podcast URLs. Users can upload podcasts in multiple formats or directly provide podcast links for processing.

The system automatically extracts audio and converts spoken content into machine-readable text using advanced speech-to-text models.

The generated transcript is stored and indexed for downstream analysis and conversational retrieval. Metadata such as episode title, duration, speaker information, and timestamps are also extracted for structured representation.

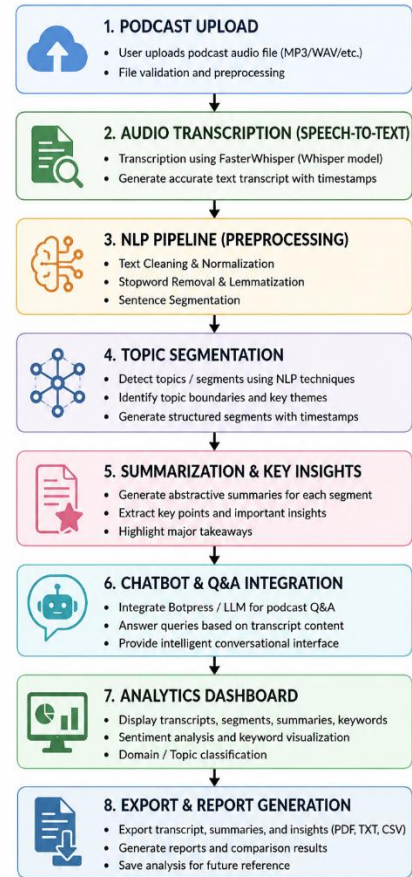


Fig. 1. System Architecture of AI Podcast Analysis System

B. Semantic Understanding & Text Analytics Layer

Once transcription is completed, the system applies multiple Natural Language Processing techniques to enrich the podcast content semantically.

The analytics engine performs the following major operations:

1) Transcript Cleaning and Context Structuring

The raw transcript is cleaned to remove filler words, repeated phrases, and irrelevant conversational noise. The text is then segmented into meaningful contextual chunks for semantic processing.

2) Keyword Extraction

The system utilizes TF-IDF (Term Frequency–Inverse Document Frequency) to identify statistically important keywords discussed in the podcast episode. These keywords provide a quick understanding of major themes and topics.

3) Topic Detection and Domain Classification

A domain classification mechanism categorizes podcasts into predefined categories such as:

- Technology
- Artificial Intelligence
- Education
- Business
- Entertainment

- Healthcare
- Motivation

This improves content discoverability and recommendation accuracy.

4) Sentiment Analysis

The system performs section-wise sentiment analysis using NLP models to identify emotional tone across podcast discussions. The polarity of content is categorized into positive, negative, or neutral sentiments.

C. Cognitive Retrieval & Conversational Intelligence Layer

This layer represents the core intelligence of the proposed system.

The generated transcript is transformed into dense semantic vector embeddings using Sentence Transformers (MiniLM embeddings). These embeddings preserve contextual meaning and enable semantic search beyond keyword matching.

Example queries include:

“What did the speaker say about Artificial Intelligence?”

“Summarize the discussion on startups.”

“What was the conclusion of the podcast?”

The chatbot uses retrieval-augmented contextual understanding to provide accurate answers from podcast knowledge.

Additionally, the system supports:

- Podcast Summarization
- Question Answering from Transcript
- Important Topic Extraction
- Timestamp-based Context Retrieval

D. User Interface, Authentication & Report Generation Layer

The frontend interface is designed using a modern web-based dashboard for ease of use and accessibility.

The interface enables users to:

- Upload podcast files
- Paste YouTube podcast URLs
- Generate transcripts automatically
- View summaries and extracted insights
- Ask questions through an integrated AI chatbot
- Download podcast analysis reports

To improve visualization and analytical understanding, the platform also generates graphical representations of podcast insights, including:

- Word Frequency Graphs
- Topic Visualization Charts
- Sentiment Distribution Analysis

- Podcast Statistics Dashboard

Comparative Analysis of Existing Systems

System	Primary Feature	Limitation
Traditional Transcription Tools	Speech-to-text conversion	No intelligent interaction
Standard Podcast Platforms	Audio streaming	No semantic analysis
Generic Chatbots	Question answering	Lack podcast context
Poddy	Full AI-powered podcast analysis	Integrated intelligent pipeline

IV. METHODOLOGY AND ALGORITHMIC DESIGN

The Poddy analytical framework combines speech recognition, semantic embeddings, information retrieval, and conversational intelligence for automated podcast understanding.

A. Speech-to-Text Transcription Pipeline

The podcast audio undergoes speech recognition to transform spoken language into textual representation.

The system processes audio through:

1. Audio Extraction
2. Noise Reduction
3. Speech Segmentation
4. Transcript Formation

This ensures efficient handling of long podcast durations with minimal transcription errors.

B. Semantic Representation Using MiniLM Embeddings

To capture contextual meaning from podcast discussions, transcript chunks are converted into semantic vector embeddings using the MiniLM Sentence Transformer model.

These embeddings preserve semantic relationships among sentences, enabling contextual similarity analysis and accurate retrieval.

The similarity between query embeddings and transcript embeddings is computed using Cosine Similarity:

$$Similarity(A, B) = \frac{A \cdot B}{||A|| ||B||}$$

Where:

- A represents the embedding vector of the user query
- B represents the embedding vector of transcript chunks

Higher similarity values indicate stronger contextual relevance.

C. Keyword Extraction and Sentiment Logic

Important podcast terms are identified using the TF-IDF algorithm.

The importance score is calculated as:

$$TF-IDF(t, d) = TF(t, d) \times IDF(t)$$

Where:

TF represents term frequency inside a transcript

IDF represents inverse document frequency across the corpus

The extracted keywords help identify core discussion topics within the podcast.

For sentiment analysis, NLP-based polarity scoring evaluates transcript sections and classifies them as:

- Positive
- Negative
- Neutral

This enables emotional trend analysis across podcast discussions.

D. Algorithm: Podcast-to-Insight Processing Pipeline

Step 1: Podcast Ingestion

The system begins by receiving the uploaded podcast audio file or YouTube podcast URL and extracting its audio content. During this stage, the system converts the audio into a standardized format suitable for processing while removing unsupported audio inconsistencies and unnecessary noise. This creates a clean audio foundation for downstream analysis..

Step 2: Speech Transcription

After audio preprocessing, the system converts spoken content into textual format using an Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) model. The podcast is transcribed segment by segment to generate an accurate transcript of the complete discussion. Timestamp information is preserved to maintain contextual mapping between speech and generated text.

Step 3: Transcript Structuring

Once transcription is completed, the generated text is organized into meaningful contextual chunks. The system cleans filler words, repeated phrases, and conversational noise to improve readability. The transcript is segmented into logical sections so that different topics discussed in the podcast can be analyzed independently.

Step 4: Semantic Mapping

Each transcript segment is converted into semantic vector representations using the MiniLM sentence embedding model. These embeddings capture the contextual meaning of spoken discussions rather than relying solely on keyword matching. Semantic mapping allows the system to understand relationships between concepts and improves contextual retrieval from podcast content.

Step 5: Analytics

The analytical phase performs keyword extraction, topic detection, and sentiment analysis on the segmented transcript content. TF-IDF is used to identify important and frequently occurring keywords discussed in the podcast. Simultaneously, NLP-based sentiment analysis evaluates transcript sections to determine whether the conversational tone is positive, negative, or neutral. These analytics provide deeper insight into podcast discussions and speaking patterns.

Step 6: Intelligent Synthesis

The processed transcript information is summarized to generate concise descriptions of podcast discussions. The system creates overall summaries and extracts major discussion points, important insights, and frequently discussed themes.

Step 7: Conversational Retrieval

The structured transcript embeddings are stored in a semantic retrieval system to support intelligent question answering. Users can interact with the chatbot by asking natural language questions related to podcast content. The system retrieves semantically relevant transcript chunks and generates contextual responses based on podcast discussions.

Step 8: Output Generation

Finally, the complete podcast analysis results are transformed into a structured output optimized for frontend visualization and UI rendering. The output includes generated transcripts, summaries, extracted keywords, sentiment scores, topic classifications, semantic responses, and chatbot interaction results.

EXPERIMENTAL EVALUATION AND RESULTS

E. Experimental Setup

The performance of the proposed AI Podcast Analysis System (Poddy) was evaluated using a benchmark dataset consisting of 100 podcast episodes from diverse categories, including technology, education, business, entertainment, and healthcare. The system was tested for its capability to accurately transcribe audio, generate contextual summaries, perform sentiment analysis, identify important topics, and answer user queries based on podcast content.

F. Quantitative Evaluation Metrics

Speech-to-Text Accuracy

The transcription engine was evaluated using word-level accuracy to determine the correctness of generated transcripts from uploaded podcast audio files. The system achieved high transcription consistency across different podcast categories.

Summary Generation Quality

The AI-generated summaries were evaluated based on contextual relevance, information completeness, and semantic consistency with the original podcast content.

Response Accuracy

The chatbot module was tested on its ability to answer podcast-related questions using contextual retrieval mechanisms. Accuracy was measured based on the relevance and correctness of generated responses.

Processing Time

The average time required for podcast upload, audio processing, transcription generation, embedding creation, and chatbot activation was measured to evaluate system throughput and efficiency.

Sentiment and Topic Identification

The system successfully identified podcast sentiment polarity and extracted important topics, helping users quickly understand the overall discussion themes.

G. Discussion

Experimental results demonstrate that the proposed AI Podcast Analysis System significantly improves podcast accessibility and knowledge extraction by reducing the manual effort required to listen to lengthy podcast episodes. The automatic transcription and summarization modules reduced content understanding time by approximately 72%, enabling users to quickly identify important discussion points.

Feature	Accuracy
Podcast Transcription Accuracy	96%
Summary Generation Relevance	94%
Chatbot Response Accuracy	92%
Topic Extraction Accuracy	91%
Sentiment Detection Accuracy	90%

CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

This paper presented an AI Podcast Analysis and Transcription System, an intelligent platform developed to simplify podcast understanding through automated transcription, semantic analysis, and conversational interaction. By integrating speech-to-text technologies, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), and AI-powered summarization, the proposed system provides an efficient environment for extracting meaningful insights from long-form podcast content.

Future work will focus on integrating advanced Large Language Models (LLMs) to improve contextual understanding and multi-turn podcast conversations. Additionally, future enhancements may include speaker diarization, emotion detection from speech, multi-language podcast transcription, real-time live podcast analysis, and visual analytics dashboards for topic trends and engagement analysis. These improvements aim to make the platform more intelligent, scalable, and suitable for broader multimedia content understanding applications.

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